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The Cuban Mop: The Near Perfect Cleaning Tool You've Never Heard of (and How to Use It)

REMODELISTA

The Cuban Mop: The Near Perfect Cleaning Tool You've Never Heard of (and How to Use It)

by **Justine Hand** Published: December 26, 2018



When it comes mops, I have a hate-hate relationship. Either I struggle to wield the heft of rope mops or find myself searching in vain for matching replacement heads



- Cuban Mop:** I bought my [Cuban Wood Mop Stick](#) from the Cuban Food Market via Amazon for \$17.95. (Note: Some Amazon reviewers were unhappy with the quality and size of this mop, but I bought it because there are not a lot of options out there. Though a bit crude in terms of finishing, my mop works great and is still nicer to look at than most. The handle, though admittedly short for taller folks, is the same length as my commercial sponge mop and is an inch longer than a Swiffer. In my opinion, this version is worth the money, but I can see an opportunity for someone to improve on craftsmanship.) You can also try a [Quickloop](#). Though smaller than a Cuban mop, it features an easy ring to secure your cloth; \$16.
- Absorbent Cotton Rag or Towel:** I bought these [Cuban Style Cloths](#), again, on Amazon for \$16, but any old rag will do. (Note: The product sample image on the Amazon page shows yellow stripes. The ones I received, shown, have blue stripes.) You could also

use any of our favorites. See: [Object Lessons: The Humble Cotton Cleaning Cloth](#).

- **Cleaning Product:** I use [Rubio Monocoat Natural Soap](#); it's a ready-to-mix concentrate for cleaning oil-treated floors.

How to Use a Cuban Mop



Above: My neighbor and model, Lizzie, gets the cloth ready.

Step 1:

Wet any absorbent, medium-size cloth—an old hand towel, dish rag, or even an old cloth diaper will work—with your favorite cleaning solution. Squeeze out the excess liquid, and lay the towel on the floor.

Note: If you want to use your Cuban mop with a dry rag, skip this step. For dust bunnies and other Swiffer-like tasks, try a microfiber cloth.



Above: Wring thoroughly.

Step 2:

Wrap the cloth around the Cuban mop as follows:



Above: Place the mop head in the center of the wet rag or towel.



Above: Starting with the bottom edge, fold one corner over the top of the mop head.



Above: Repeat this fold on the other side.



Above: Fold the top corners toward you.





Above: Then, lifting the mop head slightly, move the mop toward you just enough to capture the loose ends.

Step 3:



Above: To use, simply push the mop along the floor, being careful not to lift it off the floor. When one side gets dirty, flip the mop

and use the other side. Once both sides are soiled, remove the cloth, rinse, re-wet with cleaning solution, squeeze, and rewrap.

(Lizzie, shown using the mop, is tall, about 5'10". You can see that she is able to effectively use the mop, though a longer handle would be more comfortable for her.)



How to Clean the Cuban Mop

To clean your mop between uses, simply remove the cloth and toss in the washing machine. Easy and eco-friendly.

The right tools always make housework less of a chore. Here are more of our cleaning favorites: